The Identity Capital Index: A Structural Reconstruction

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PART I: THE HONEST DIAGNOSIS — WHAT'S BROKEN IN THE CURRENT FRAMEWORK

1. The Pillar Inconsistency Problem

Across your four documents, the ICI has four different configurations:

Document	Pillar 1	Pillar 2	Pillar 3	Pillar 4
Developing ICI	Place Attachment	Narrative Resilience	Vernacular Integration	Social Stickiness
Beirut vs Doha	Vernacular Integration	Social Stickiness	Narrative Resilience	Place Attachment
Global Strategy	Architectural Syntax	Narrative Density	Sensory Fidelity	Social Capital
Quantifying ICI	Architectural Syntax	Narrative Depth	Environmental Specificity	Social Cohesion

This is not just a naming problem. The *content* shifts between documents. "Vernacular Integration" in the Developing doc includes Space Syntax + Fractal Analysis + UTCI (bioclimatic). By the Quantifying doc, the climate metrics have been separated into their own "Environmental Specificity" pillar that now also includes soundscapes and smellscapes. Sensory Fidelity appears in the Global Strategy but vanishes in the case study.

The problem for a client: If an RCU director reads the case study, then sees the Quantifying doc, they see two different products. This destroys credibility before the first meeting.

The fix: One canonical framework. One set of names. One structure. Forever. Every subsequent document references this master architecture.

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2. The Weighting Contradiction

- **Developing ICI** says: Use PCA (Principal Component Analysis) — let the data determine weights statistically.

- **Quantifying ICI** says: Use AHP (Analytic Hierarchy Process) — let an expert panel determine weights through pairwise comparison.

These are fundamentally different philosophies. PCA is empirical (bottom-up, data-driven). AHP is judgmental (top-down, expert-driven). You cannot claim both without looking like you haven't decided.

The deeper problem with PCA: PCA requires a benchmark dataset of 30+ scored districts to extract meaningful principal components. You don't have this dataset. You have three case studies (Masdar, Msheireb, World Islands) plus the Beirut-Doha comparison. That's not enough for PCA to be statistically valid. Claiming PCA without the dataset is an invitation for any serious quant to tear you apart.

The deeper problem with AHP: AHP is honest about subjectivity, but it's also manipulable. A panel of experts will produce different weights depending on who's in the room. A Qatari heritage official will weight Narrative Depth differently than a Dubai real estate developer.

The fix: Use AHP as the primary weighting method, but position the contextual flexibility as a *feature*, not a bug. Call it "Context-Adaptive Weighting." Build a default weight set based on literature synthesis for the calculator, and reserve custom AHP sessions for paid engagements. Retire the PCA claim until you have 30+ scored districts in your database.

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3. The Two-Product Confusion

Your framework tries to be two things simultaneously:

Product A: Pre-Construction Audit — Scoring a masterplan *before* it's built using VR walkthroughs, survey projections, and design analysis. This is the "crystal ball" product.

Product B: Post-Occupancy Diagnostic — Scoring an *existing* district using real footfall data, occupancy rates, survey data, and observed behavior. This is the "health check" product.

These require different data inputs, different methodologies, and different validation logic. The Developing doc explicitly frames ICI as pre-construction. The Beirut-Doha case study applies it post-hoc. The Global Strategy sells it as both.

The fix: Split them explicitly. The **ICI-D** (Design) is the pre-construction audit. The **ICI-P** (Performance) is the post-occupancy diagnostic. Same six dimensions, different data sources. The calculator on the website is a simplified ICI-D.

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4. The Sub-Metric Bloat Problem

Across the four documents, you've introduced approximately 35-40 distinct sub-metrics. Here's a partial inventory:

- Place Identity (PI-1 through PI-4)

- Place Dependence (PD-1 through PD-3)
- Attachment-Retention Coefficient (ARC)
- Attachment Density (AD) via PPGIS
- Narrative Transportation Scale (12 items)
- Index of Vernacular Semiotics (IVS)
- Heritage Premium (hedonic regression)
- Fractal Dimension (D) via box-counting
- NACH (Normalized Angular Choice)
- UTCI / Comfort Hours Improvement (CHI)
- Stationary Activity Index (SAI)
- Sense of Community Index (SCI-2, 24 items)
- Vibrancy Density (Vd)
- Spatial Intelligibility Index
- Visual Entropy (Shannon)
- Architectural Life Score ($L = T \times H$)
- Narrative Density Index
- Narrative Coherence Score
- Mnemonic Resonance Score
- Microclimate Diversity Index
- Acoustic Complexity Index (ACI)
- Scentmark Density
- Luminosity Rarity Score
- Bridging/Bonding Ratio
- Collective Efficacy Scale
- Neighboring Behavior Scale
- Third Place Index (TPI)
- Third Place Observational Index (TPOI)
- Stationary Activity Index (repeated)

The problem: No client will sit through a presentation with 35+ metrics. More importantly, many of these are *research-grade* measurements that require specialized equipment (ENVI-met licenses, depthmapX, e-nose sensors, gas chromatography-mass spectrometry). A consultancy that lists GC-MS as part of its methodology needs a lab, not an office.

The fix: Ruthless hierarchy. Six dimensions. Three sub-indicators per dimension (18 total). Each sub-indicator maps to a specific data collection method with a clear cost tier (Tier 1: desk research; Tier 2: fieldwork; Tier 3: specialized simulation). The calculator uses Tier 1 data only.

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5. The Sensory Pillar Weakness

The smellscape and soundscape metrics are intellectually fascinating but practically indefensible in a client meeting. Here's why:

- **No benchmark data exists.** There's no global database of "Scentmark Density" for cities. You'd be scoring against... what?
- **Measurement is expensive and unreproducible.** Smellwalks with trained panelists are subjective. E-nose technology is unreliable outdoors. GC-MS analysis of VOCs is a chemistry lab exercise, not a consulting deliverable.
- **The correlation to economic value is speculative.** The 0.9% premium per decibel of noise reduction is a real finding, but it measures noise *reduction*, not "sonic distinctiveness." A quiet suburb scores well on noise reduction but has zero cultural sonic identity.

The fix: Fold sensory elements into the Environmental Specificity dimension as a qualitative sub-indicator, not a quantitative metric. Acknowledge them in the narrative. Don't try to calculate a "Scentmark Density Score" with decimal precision.

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6. The Circular Scoring Problem

The Developing doc says ICI is scaled such that "Benchmark = 50, Standard Deviation = 10." But the benchmark is defined as "highly successful existing districts (e.g., Souq Waqif, Msheireb)." Then in the case study, Msheireb scores 85/100, not 50.

This means either:

- The benchmark has shifted, or
- The scoring system isn't internally consistent, or
- The 0-100 scale in the case study is qualitative, not derived from the Z-score methodology

The fix: Be honest about what's qualitative and what's quantitative. The case study scores are expert assessments (calibrated judgment). The full ICI-P uses quantitative data. Don't pretend the case study numbers came out of a PCA pipeline.

PART II: THE RECONSTRUCTED FRAMEWORK

The Identity Capital Index v2.0: Six Dimensions

Based on my analysis of your four documents, the academic literature you cite, and what the market (development authorities, SWFs, heritage consultancies, real estate investors) actually needs to make decisions, here is the restructured ICI.

Why Six Dimensions, Not Four

Your four-pillar model conflates things that should be separated:

1. "Vernacular Integration" in the original mixes *spatial connectivity* (a morphological property) with *climate response* (a thermodynamic property). These are independent variables. A district can be well-connected but thermally hostile (Solidere), or thermally comfortable but spatially isolated (a walled resort).
2. "Social Stickiness" and "Place Attachment" overlap significantly. Place Attachment surveys ask "would you stay?" while Social Stickiness metrics measure "do people linger?" These are related but the first is psychological (projected) and the second is behavioral (observed). They need to be distinct.
3. There's no explicit economic dimension. Your hedonic pricing and walkability premium data are scattered across multiple pillars. But for the clients who write checks (SWFs, investors, developers), the economic validation IS the punchline.

THE SIX DIMENSIONS

Dimension 1: MORPHOLOGICAL INTEGRATION (MI)

"How well does the physical form connect to its context?"

What it measures: The topological and geometric logic of the urban form. Does the street network facilitate natural movement and encounter? Does the architecture speak the visual grammar of its environment?

Sub-indicators:

Sub-Indicator	Metric	Data Source	Method
Spatial Connectivity	Integration (Rn) & Choice (Rn) from Space Syntax	CAD/GIS of street network	depthmapX analysis
Spatial Intelligibility	Pearson r between Connectivity and Global Integration	CAD/GIS of street network	depthmapX analysis
Fractal Coherence	Fractal Dimension (D) via box-counting	Facade elevations / street photos	ImageJ or FracLac

Scoring Logic:

- Spatial Connectivity: Compare Integration and Choice values to a regional reference set (e.g., historic medinas, successful mixed-use districts). Score on percentile rank.
- Intelligibility: r > 0.5 = High (score 8-10); r 0.3-0.5 = Medium (5-7); r < 0.3 = Low (1-4).

- Fractal Coherence: D in [1.3, 1.5] = High (8-10); D in [1.2, 1.3] or [1.5, 1.6] = Medium (5-7); D < 1.2 or D > 1.6 = Low (1-4).

Default Weight: 20%

Rationale: Morphology is the skeleton. It determines movement patterns, which determine encounter rates, which determine social and economic outcomes. It's the most objective, least manipulable dimension. Space Syntax has 40+ years of validated research. This is your hardest data point.

Dimension 2: CLIMATIC INTELLIGENCE (CI)

"How does the design respond to its environment?"

What it measures: The thermodynamic performance of the outdoor environment. Does the design extend the comfortable outdoor season? Does it leverage passive strategies or fight the climate with mechanical brute force?

Sub-indicators:

Sub-Indicator	Metric	Data Source	Method
Thermal Comfort	Comfort Hours Improvement (CHI) based on UTCI	TMY weather files + masterplan geometry	ENVI-met / RayMan
Passive Design Integration	Vernacular Adaptation Score (shading coefficient, aspect ratio, albedo)	Design documents + material specs	Analytical assessment
Sensory Environment	Qualitative assessment of acoustic and olfactory coherence	Site observation / design intent	Expert panel scoring

Scoring Logic:

- Thermal Comfort: CHI > 30% improvement over unshaded baseline = High (8-10). CHI 10-30% = Medium (5-7). CHI < 10% = Low (1-4).
- Passive Design: Scored against a checklist of vernacular strategies appropriate to the climate zone (GCC: shading, wind channels, thermal mass, albedo; Mediterranean: cross-ventilation, thermal mass, courtyard; Temperate: solar gain, wind break).
- Sensory Environment: Expert panel scores the coherence between the sensory profile and the cultural context. This is explicitly qualitative.

Default Weight: 15%

Rationale: In the GCC, this is arguably the most important dimension (outdoor comfort determines whether anyone actually *uses* the street). In temperate climates, it's less critical. The default weight of 15% is the global average; AHP tuning for GCC projects would push this to 20-25%. Reduced from a full pillar to acknowledge that sensory metrics (smell, sound) are currently too speculative for quantitative scoring.

Dimension 3: NARRATIVE DEPTH (ND)

"How many stories can this place tell?"

What it measures: The density, authenticity, and resilience of the cultural narratives embedded in (or projected onto) the site. Does the place have roots, or is it a stage set?

Sub-indicators:

Sub-Indicator	Metric	Data Source	Method
Heritage Stratigraphy	Number of distinct historical layers (archaeological, architectural, intangible) per hectare	Historical records, archaeological surveys, UNESCO/national listings	Desk research + Deep Mapping
Semiotic Authenticity	Index of Vernacular Semiotics (IVS): ratio of locally-rooted to globally-generic naming/signage	Design documents, naming strategy, signage plan	Content analysis
Narrative Transportation	Modified Transportation Scale score (abbreviated 6-item version)	Survey of target demographic	Psychometric survey (VR or rendered walkthrough)

Scoring Logic:

- Heritage Stratigraphy: ⩾3 distinct layers = High (8-10); 1-2 layers = Medium (5-7); Greenfield with no heritage context = Low (1-4). Bonus points for UNESCO/national designation and ICH (Intangible Cultural Heritage) associations.
- Semiotic Authenticity: IVS 0.4-0.7 = High (8-10); IVS 0.2-0.4 or 0.7-0.9 = Medium (5-7); IVS < 0.2 (corporate wasteland) or > 0.9 (theme park pastiche) = Low (1-4).
- Narrative Transportation: Mean score > 5.0/7.0 = High; 3.5-5.0 = Medium; < 3.5 = Low.

Default Weight: 20%

Rationale: This is where Salam Abi Karam has its deepest expertise and where you differentiate from every engineering firm on earth. Narrative Depth is the dimension no one else measures.

It's also the dimension most correlated with heritage premiums in hedonic pricing studies (the β_3 coefficient you cite). Your case study data (Msheireb's authentic narrative vs. Solidere's "architecture of amnesia") provides the most compelling evidence for this pillar's predictive power.

Dimension 4: SOCIAL INFRASTRUCTURE (SI)

"What is the physical capacity for social interaction?"

What it measures: The built environment's capacity to generate and sustain social encounters. Not whether people *feel* connected (that's Place Attachment), but whether the *physical design* enables connection.

Sub-indicators:

Sub-Indicator	Metric	Data Source	Method
Third Place Density	Number of non-commercial or low-barrier social spaces per 1,000 projected residents	Masterplan zoning schedule, ground-floor use plan	Analytical assessment
Edge Quality	Presence of "active edges" (Gehl criteria): transparent facades, seating, intermediate zones between building and street	Design documents, facade sections	Gehl-method audit
Use Diversity	Shannon Entropy of land use categories within a 400m walking radius of any point	Zoning/program schedule	GIS analysis

Scoring Logic:

- Third Place Density: Scored against the benchmark of high-performing mixed-use districts. The key distinction is between *transactional* spaces (you must buy something to sit) and *civic* spaces (free to occupy). Msheireb's Baraha scores high; a district where every seat belongs to a cafe scores lower.
- Edge Quality: Binary checklist per Gehl's 12 Quality Criteria, weighted toward Comfort and Protection in hot climates. Score = percentage of criteria met.
- Use Diversity: High Shannon Entropy (fine-grained mixing) = High. Low entropy (monoculture: all residential, all office) = Low. The 400m radius captures the "15-minute city" logic.

Default Weight: 15%

Rationale: Social Infrastructure is the *physical precondition* for social capital. It's measurable from design documents without surveys, making it the most actionable dimension for architects and masterplanners. Weighted slightly lower than Morphological Integration and Narrative Depth because it's more easily fixable (you can add benches and cafes; you can't retrofit a street grid or invent heritage).

Dimension 5: PLACE ATTACHMENT POTENTIAL (PAP)

"Will people form an emotional bond with this place?"

What it measures: The projected psychological bond between the user and the place. This is the "demand-side" dimension — not what the place *provides*, but what the user *feels*.

Sub-indicators:

Sub-Indicator	Metric	Data Source	Method
Place Identity	Modified Williams & Vaske PI scale (4 items, 5-point Likert)	Survey of target demographic	Psychometric survey
Place Dependence	Modified Williams & Vaske PD scale (3 items, 5-point Likert)	Survey of target demographic	Psychometric survey
Attachment-Retention Gap	Divergence between PI and PD scores	Derived from above	Analytical

Scoring Logic:

- PI and PD: Mean scores on validated Likert scales. Internal consistency verified by Cronbach's alpha > 0.80.
- The Attachment-Retention Gap is the diagnostic insight:
  - High PI + High PD = "The Gold Standard" (score 9-10). Emotional and functional lock-in.
  - High PI + Low PD = "Tourism Syndrome" (score 5-6). Love the concept, can't live there.
  - Low PI + High PD = "Functional Lock-in" (score 4-5). Trapped by necessity, no loyalty.
  - Low PI + Low PD = "Ghost Town Risk" (score 1-3). No reason to come, no reason to stay.

Default Weight: 15%

Rationale: This is the only dimension that requires primary survey research, which makes it the most expensive to measure but also the most directly predictive of retention and churn. For the web calculator, this dimension is estimated via proxy questions (not full psychometric scales). For full engagements, this is where the VR walkthrough and n=500 survey protocol kicks in.

Dimension 6: ECONOMIC RESILIENCE (ER)

"Can this place survive a storm?"

What it measures: The economic structure's resistance to shocks. This is the "so what?" dimension — it translates identity into investable metrics.

Sub-indicators:

Sub-Indicator	Metric	Data Source	Method
Revenue Diversity	Herfindahl-Hirschman Index (HHI) of income sources (residential, office, retail, hospitality, cultural, government)	Financial pro forma / zoning schedule	Analytical
Heritage Premium Potential	Estimated β_3 coefficient from hedonic regression (proximity to heritage assets)	Market comparables + heritage inventory	Hedonic pricing model
Demand Resilience	Ratio of "daily needs" economy to "discretionary" economy; ratio of local to non-local demand dependency	Tenant mix / demographic targeting	Analytical assessment

Scoring Logic:

- Revenue Diversity: Low HHI (diversified) = High score. High HHI (concentrated) = Low score. Solidere's dependence on luxury retail and Gulf tourism is a textbook High HHI vulnerability.
- Heritage Premium: Estimated % premium on property values attributable to heritage/narrative assets. Literature range: 4.4% to 23% depending on context. Score based on estimated premium bracket.
- Demand Resilience: High local/daily-needs ratio = High resilience. High tourist/discretionary ratio = Low resilience. The Beirut case study is the definitive cautionary tale here.

Default Weight: 15%

Rationale: This is the closer. When you sit across from a sovereign wealth fund CIO or a real estate PE partner, they don't care about fractal dimensions. They care about "will this asset hold its value in a downturn?" Economic Resilience translates every other dimension into the language of risk and return. It's also the dimension that validates the ICI retroactively: Msheireb (94% occupancy, $15M+ visitors) vs. Solidere (net losses, 82% revenue collapse) proves that high ICI predicts economic outperformance.

THE AGGREGATION MODEL

The ICI Score

$$ICI = (MI \times w_1) + (CI \times w_2) + (ND \times w_3) + (SI \times w_4) + (PAP \times w_5) + (ER \times w_6)$$

Where each dimension score is on a 0-10 scale, and the weighted sum produces a 0-100 score.

Default Weights (Global Baseline)

Dimension	Code	Default Weight	Rationale
Morphological Integration	MI	20%	Hardest data, highest predictive validity for movement/encounter
Climatic Intelligence	CI	15%	Critical in extreme climates, less so in temperate zones
Narrative Depth	ND	20%	Salam Abi Karam's core differentiator; strongest heritage premium correlation
Social Infrastructure	SI	15%	Actionable, measurable from design docs
Place Attachment Potential	PAP	15%	Most directly predictive of retention/churn
Economic Resilience	ER	15%	The "so what" — translates identity into investment language

Total: 100%

Context-Adaptive Weights (AHP Tuning)

For paid engagements, an AHP session with the client's expert panel adjusts weights to context:

Context	MI	CI	ND	SI	PAP	ER
GCC New District	15%	25%	15%	15%	15%	15%
European Heritage Site	15%	10%	30%	15%	15%	15%
Post-Conflict Reconstruction	10%	10%	25%	20%	20%	15%
Luxury Hospitality	15%	15%	25%	10%	15%	20%
Affordable Housing/Community	20%	15%	10%	20%	20%	15%

THE SCORING BANDS

ICI Score	Rating	Interpretation
80-100	**Sovereign**	Self-sustaining identity ecosystem. Resilient to economic shocks. Generates premium.
60-79	**Rooted**	Strong foundations with specific deficiencies. Targeted interventions can unlock value.
40-59	**Functional**	Technically adequate but identity-fragile. Vulnerable to competition and market shifts.
20-39	**Fragile**	Significant identity deficits. High churn risk. Requires structural redesign.
0-19	**Void**	No identity capital. "Ghost Town" trajectory.

Retrospective Calibration (Your Case Studies)

District	MI	CI	ND	SI	PAP	ER	ICI	Rating
Msheireb Downtown Doha	9	9	8	8	8	9	**85**	Sovereign
Solidere BCD (pre-2019)	5	3	4	3	3	3	**36**	Fragile
Solidere BCD (2025)	6	3	5	4	3	2	**39**	Fragile
Masdar City	4	8	5	3	3	4	**44**	Functional
The World Islands	1	2	1	1	2	1	**13**	Void
Souq Waqif (reference)	8	7	9	9	9	8	**84**	Sovereign
Gemmayze/Mar Mikhael	7	4	8	8	9	5	**68**	Rooted

These calibration scores are expert assessments, not algorithmic outputs. They serve as the anchor points for the eventual quantitative model.

PART III: WHAT THE MARKET ACTUALLY WANTS

Client Type 1: Sovereign Wealth Funds / Development Authorities (PIF, RCU, Mubadala, Qatar Foundation)

What they need: Risk metrics for mega-investments. "Will this $5B district retain value in 20 years?"

What they buy: The full ICI engagement ($150K-$500K). Pre-construction audit with VR surveys, Space Syntax modeling, ENVI-met simulation, and a 100-page diagnostic report with recommendations.

What convinces them: The Msheireb vs. Solidere comparison. Hard numbers: 94% occupancy vs. net losses. 15M visitors vs. "ghost town" coverage. The ICI predicted this divergence. Your next project doesn't need to learn Solidere's lesson the expensive way.

The ICI feature they care about most: Economic Resilience + Climatic Intelligence. They want to know the project won't become an air-conditioned liability.

Client Type 2: Heritage Consultancies / Architecture Firms (BOP, AECOM, Arup, Foster + Partners)

What they need: A methodology they can sub-contract or license. They win the masterplan contract; they need someone to do the "identity audit" component they can't do themselves.

What they buy: The ICI-as-a-service ($50K-$150K per project). You embed in their team for 3-6 months. You deliver the Narrative Depth and Place Attachment dimensions; they handle the engineering.

What convinces them: Your BOP pitch conversation. You're not competing for their contract; you're filling the gap they know they have. The pitch: "You build the hardware. We audit the software."

The ICI feature they care about most: Narrative Depth + Morphological Integration. They want data that improves their design decisions.

Client Type 3: Luxury Hospitality Groups (Aman, Rosewood, Six Senses, Habitas)

What they need: Cultural depth for "sense of place" programming. They charge $2,000/night; they need a story worth $2,000.

What they buy: The Narrative Depth dimension as a standalone product ($30K-$80K). Deep research on site heritage, sensory profiling, and a "Cultural Director's Brief" that informs architecture, interior design, F&B, and guest experience.

What convinces them: Specificity. Anyone can write a mood board. You can tell them the exact Ottoman-era trade route that passed through their site, the specific native botanicals that create the "scent of place," and the local myth that should name their restaurant.

The ICI feature they care about most: Narrative Depth + Climatic Intelligence (sensory sub-component).

Client Type 4: International Development / Post-Conflict (World Bank, UN-Habitat, Aga Khan Trust)

What they need: A framework that measures whether reconstruction builds social cohesion, not just buildings.

What they buy: The ICI-P (Performance) applied to reconstruction projects ($50K-$200K). Post-occupancy diagnostics that measure whether the rebuilt district is generating social capital or cementing sectarian divides.

What convinces them: The Solidere case as "what not to do." Your Beirut expertise is not a liability here; it's your credentials. You lived through the failure. You can diagnose it. You can prevent it elsewhere.

The ICI feature they care about most: Social Infrastructure + Place Attachment + Narrative Depth. Does the reconstruction reconnect communities or segregate them?

PART IV: THE WEB CALCULATOR — LEAD GENERATION ENGINE

Design Philosophy

The web calculator is NOT the full ICI. It's the "free sample" that demonstrates the framework's logic and creates urgency. Think of it as a BMI calculator for cities: useful enough to be sticky, limited enough to require professional follow-up.

How It Works

15 questions, 3-5 minutes to complete.

The user inputs basic information about a district or development project. The calculator produces a preliminary ICI score with a dimensional breakdown and a "risk profile."

Question Architecture (3 questions per dimension, minus PAP which is estimated)

Morphological Integration (3 questions)

1. "What is the dominant block size?" [< 60m / 60-120m / 120-200m / > 200m] — Proxy for permeability
2. "How many street connections exist at the district boundary per km of perimeter?" [< 4 / 4-8 / 8-12 / > 12] — Proxy for integration
3. "Does the architectural language include detail visible at the 1-10m scale (ornament, texture, material variation)?" [None / Minimal / Moderate / Rich] — Proxy for fractal coherence

Climatic Intelligence (3 questions) 4. "What percentage of primary pedestrian routes are shaded (canopy, arcade, overhang) at solar noon in summer?" [< 20% / 20-50% / 50-80% / > 80%] 5. "Does the street orientation leverage prevailing winds for natural ventilation?" [No / Partially / Deliberately designed] 6. "What is the primary exterior material palette?" [Dark/heat-absorbing / Mixed / Light/high-albedo / Vernacular-adapted]

Narrative Depth (3 questions) 7. "How many distinct historical periods are represented in the site's heritage?" [None (greenfield) / 1 / 2-3 / 4+] 8. "What proportion of place names, signage, and public art reference local history, dialect, or ecology vs. generic global naming?" [< 20% local / 20-50% / 50-80% / > 80%] 9. "Is there an existing intangible cultural heritage (festivals, crafts, oral traditions) associated with the site?" [None / Some / Significant / UNESCO-recognized]

Social Infrastructure (3 questions) 10. "How many non-commercial public gathering spaces (squares, parks, community facilities) exist per 1,000 planned residents?" [0 / 1-2 / 3-5 / 6+] 11. "What percentage of ground-floor frontage is 'active' (transparent, accessible, human-scale)?" [< 20% / 20-50% / 50-80% / > 80%] 12. "How many distinct land use categories exist within a 5-minute walk of the center?" [1-2 / 3-4 / 5-6 / 7+]

Economic Resilience (3 questions) 13. "What percentage of projected revenue comes from a single source (e.g., luxury retail, tourism, office)?" [> 60% / 40-60% / 20-40% / < 20%] 14. "What is the ratio of 'daily needs' tenants (grocery, pharmacy, schools) to 'discretionary' tenants (luxury, entertainment)?" [< 20% daily / 20-40% / 40-60% / > 60%] 15. "How dependent is projected demand on non-resident visitors (tourists, commuters from outside the district)?" [> 70% non-resident / 50-70% / 30-50% / < 30%]

Place Attachment (estimated, not asked directly)

- The calculator estimates PAP from a combination of ND score (high narrative = higher emotional resonance), SI score (more social infrastructure = higher functional attachment), and the user's response to Q8 (semiotic authenticity correlates with identity formation).

Output

The Preliminary ICI Score: 0-100 with dimensional breakdown shown as a hexagonal radar chart.

The Risk Profile: The two lowest-scoring dimensions are flagged as "Critical Risk Areas" with a brief explanation of why they matter (1-2 sentences each).

The Call to Action: "Your preliminary ICI score suggests [Fragile/Functional/Rooted] identity capital. A full ICI audit would provide detailed diagnostics with actionable recommendations across all six dimensions. [Request a consultation]"

The Email Gate: The full radar chart and risk profile are visible immediately. A downloadable PDF "Identity Diagnostic Brief" (2 pages) is gated behind an email capture.

PART V: CRITICAL FAILURE MODES & HONEST RISKS

Risk 1: "Who Validates the Validator?"

The ICI is self-referential until you have third-party validation. Academic peer review of the methodology, or independent replication by a research institution, would be transformative. Consider partnering with a university (UCL Space Syntax Lab is the obvious choice; King's College London Geography; AUB Urbanism) to publish a validation study.

Risk 2: The PCA Temptation

Do not claim PCA until you have 30+ scored districts. It will take 2-3 years of consulting engagements to build this dataset. That's fine. AHP is defensible for now. But be transparent that the default weights are "literature-calibrated expert estimates," not statistically derived.

Risk 3: The "Six Dimensions" vs. "Four Pillars" Transition

Your existing materials say four pillars. Your verbal pitch says six dimensions. You need a clear narrative for why it's now six. The answer: "Our initial framework grouped environmental and spatial analysis into a single 'Vernacular' pillar. As we refined the methodology through case studies, we found that morphological and climatic factors are independently predictive of different outcomes — connectivity predicts encounter rates while climate predicts dwell time — so we separated them for greater diagnostic precision. Similarly, we added Economic Resilience as a standalone dimension because our Solidere-Msheireb comparison proved that identity directly predicts financial performance."

Risk 4: Defending Against "This Is Just Vibes"

The strongest objection you'll face: "This is just a fancy way to dress up subjective opinion as a number." Your defense: (1) Space Syntax is peer-reviewed with 40+ years of validation. (2) UTCI is ISO-standard. (3) Williams & Vaske place attachment scales have Cronbach's alpha > 0.80. (4) Hedonic pricing is standard real estate methodology. (5) The case studies provide retroactive validation — the ICI correctly "predicts" the Solidere collapse and the Msheireb success. The subjective elements (Narrative Depth, Sensory Environment) are explicitly labeled as expert assessments, not pseudo-science. Honest subjectivity is more defensible than false objectivity.

Risk 5: The Scope Creep Trap

The Global Strategy document positions Salam Abi Karam as a rival to McKinsey and Bain. This is aspirational but currently incredible. You are two people. McKinsey has 45,000 consultants. The ICI calculator and a few high-profile case studies don't make you a Tier 1 strategy house. What they do make you is an extremely specialized niche firm with proprietary IP that Tier 1 firms need to license. That's the more honest and more lucrative positioning in the near term.